

Executive Interview Questions

Questions that expose the real mandate and decision architecture

Questions 01-08

01. What business outcome caused this role to be opened now?
02. Where does AI demand enter, and who can fund, sequence or stop it?
03. What evidence separates an experiment, pilot and production service?
04. Which guest or team-member moments carry the greatest opportunity and constraint?
05. Which data, identity, cloud, device or observability boundaries constrain scale?
06. How are override, escalation and stop rights designed?
07. What testing and recovery expectations apply by risk tier?
08. How are technical, product, cyber, privacy, legal and operations teams accountable after launch?

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Questions 09-16

- 09. Where is the team strongest, and which capabilities must be recruited or developed?
- 10. Which vendors or APIs create leverage or unacceptable continuity risk?
- 11. How are ROI, cost-to-serve, reuse and operating benefits measured?
- 12. What has made prior technology changes stick or fail with users?
- 13. Which privacy, fairness, explainability or regulatory issues shape the roadmap?
- 14. How are incidents converted into reusable controls?
- 15. What would make the first year unmistakably successful?
- 16. What concern about my background should be resolved before trusting me with this mandate?

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Listening Guide

Listen for ownership that is implied rather than named.

Listen for evidence fragmented across technical and business teams.

Listen for responsibility changing hands at the production boundary.

Listen for guest consequences missing from architecture decisions.

Closing Question

Which answer would most change how you expect this director to operate in the first 120 days?